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YAADCARD.IN

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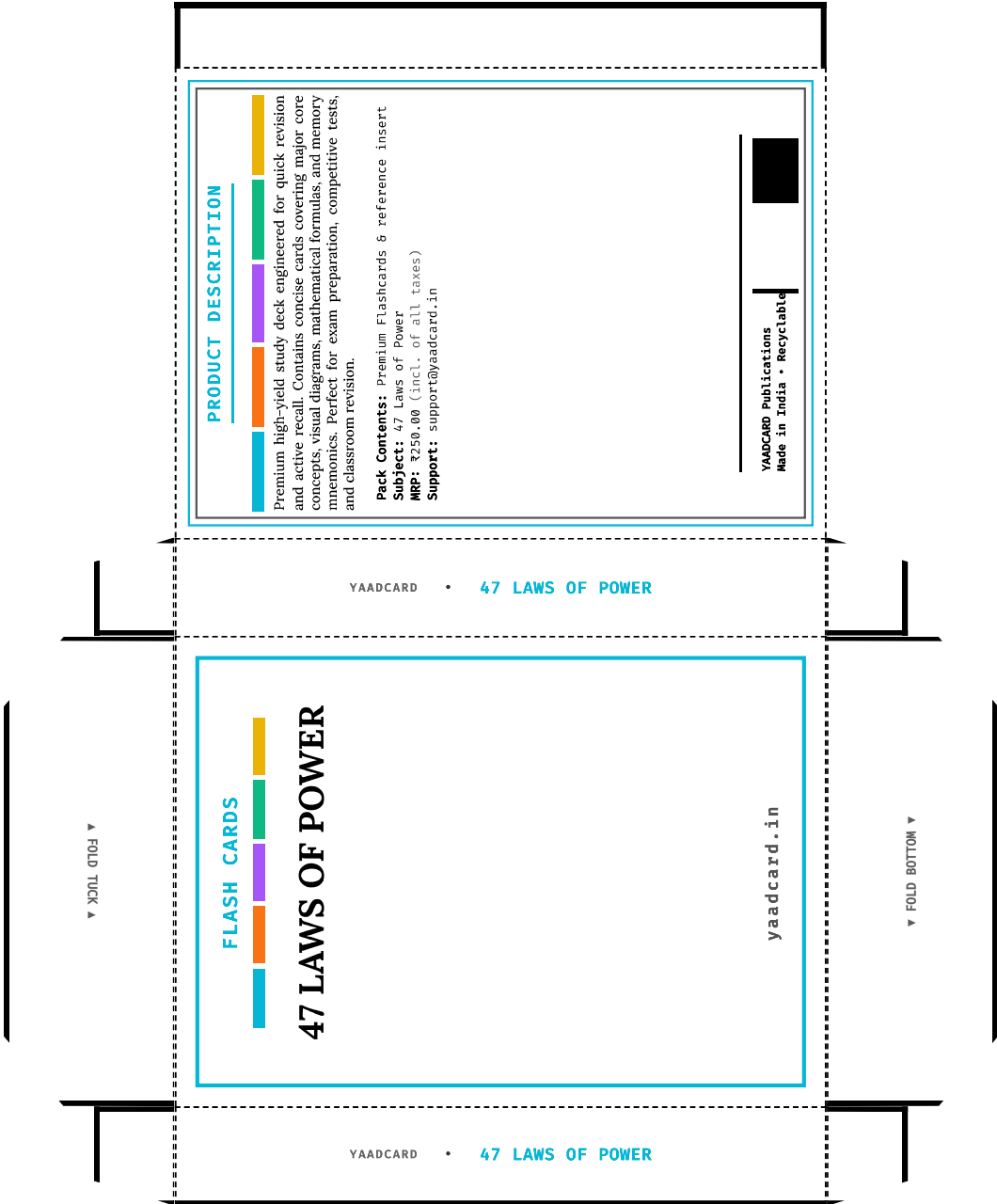
YAADCARD.IN

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KEEP
THEM
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LAW 5

Reputation is your power's cornerstone.

Protect reputation fiercely; it is the core pillar of power over others.

State	Effect
Strong rep	Deters attack
Weak rep	Invites attack

[Reputation] = Shield

LAW 4

Silence appears powerful, deep.

The less you say, the more impressive and mysterious you seem to others.

Vague words seem profound
Talking too much invites errors

[Silence] —> [Mystery]

LAW 3

Keep people off-balance, unsure.

Hide your true goals using smokescreens so opponents cannot prepare a defense.

Use decoys to mislead rivals
Reveal plans only after acting

Plan A (mask) hides Plan B

LAW 2

Distrust friends, cultivate former foes.

Friends betray easily out of envy, a hired former enemy proves loyalty to earn trust.

Friends grow envious quicker
Enemies work harder to prove loyalty

Foe —loyalty—> Ally

LAW 1

Make superiors feel superior always.

Never make those above you feel insecure by showing off your talents too openly.

Let others take credit for ideas
Insecurity in a master breeds danger

You < Boss (perceived)

DECK INDEX • PART 2

25: Re-create Yourself

26: Keep Hands Clean

27: Cutlike Following

28: Enter Boldly

29: Plan the End

30: Effortless Mastery

31: Control the Options

32: Play Fantasies

33: Find Thumbscrew

34: Be Royal

35: Master Timing

36: Disdain What's Lost

37: Compelling Spectacles

38: Blend in Outwardly

39: Stir the Waters

40: Despise Free Lunch

41: Avoid Great Shoes

42: Strike the Shepherd

43: Win Hearts, Minds

44: Mirror Effect

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LAW 8

Lure targets to your ground.

Force others to come to you by dangling tempting bait, giving you the advantage.

Choosing terrain gives control
Patience beats chasing targets

[Bait] —> [Target moves]

LAW 7

Let others labor, you shine.

Use the wisdom, knowledge, and legwork of others while claiming the final glory.

Delegate effort to skilled aides
Credit boosts your image only

Their work —> Your credit

LAW 6

Stand out, be seen loudly.

Get noticed at all costs; being visible and talked about creates power and opportunity.

Notoriety beats being ignored
Mystery and scandal attract eyes

[You] —spotlight—> [Crowd]

LAW 11

Dependence guarantees ongoing loyalty.

Make others need your skills or resources continuously so they can never discard you.

Indispensability secures your position
Teach less than they need

[They need You] = Safety

LAW 10

Misery and bad luck spread fast.

Distance yourself from unhappy, unlucky people whose negativity can drag you down too.

Negativity is contagious socially
Associate with positive, lucky people

[Gloom] —spreads—> [You]

LAW 9

Actions persuade better than words.

Demonstrating results silences doubt better than any argument or explanation ever could.

Arguments breed resentment, doubt
Proof through deeds wins trust

[Action] > [Words]

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SUCKER

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PLAN
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LAW 17 Unpredictability keeps others uneasy. Cultivate an unpredictable air; controlled unpredictability intimidates and keeps rivals guessing. Predictability lets others control you Randomness creates fear and power [?] → [Unease]	LAW 16 Scarcity increases perceived value. Withdrawing your presence occasionally makes people respect and desire you more strongly. Too much presence breeds contempt Absence rekindles respect and desire [Gone] → [Missed]	LAW 15 A wounded enemy still bites. Defeat rivals completely; a half-crushed foe will recover and seek revenge later. Half-victories invite retaliation Total defeat ends the threat [Enemy] → [0%]	LAW 14 Gather intel while seeming friendly. Act as an ally while quietly collecting information about rivals' plans and weaknesses. Friendly talk reveals real intent Information is a strategic weapon [Friend mask] → [Intel]	LAW 13 Offer benefit, not sympathy pleas. When requesting favors, show what's in it for them rather than asking for mercy. Gratitude fades, self-interest lasts Frame requests as mutual gain [Their gain] → [Your favor]	LAW 12 One honest act disarms suspicion. A single sincere gesture of honesty or generosity can mask deceptive intentions completely. Trust opens doors for tricks Save the gesture, use sparingly [Kind act] → [Guard drops]
LAW 23 Focus energy, don't spread thin. Direct all your resources into one strong area rather than scattering effort thinly. Deep focus beats wide spread One strong pool outperforms many [All energy] → [1 point]	LAW 22 Yield now, strike back later. When weaker, surrender instead of fighting; use the pause to rebuild strength and plan. Fighting when weak wastes power Surrender buys time to recover [Yield] → [Regroup]	LAW 21 Seeming dumb catches the smart. Feign naivety so overconfident opponents lower their guard, making them easier to deceive. Overconfidence blinds clever targets Appearing dumb hides real intent [Dumb act] → [Trap]	LAW 20 Neutrality preserves your bargaining power. Avoid committing fully to any side; staying independent lets you play all sides. Sides use committed allies up Neutral parties gain more leverage [A] [You] [B]	LAW 19 Wrong target brings costly retaliation. Study who you're dealing with; offending the wrong person invites serious, lasting trouble. Different people need different tactics Misjudging targets brings backlash [Study] → [Right move]	LAW 18 Fortresses cut you off, weaken. Isolating yourself for safety actually cuts off vital information and support networks. Isolation blocks useful information Mingling protects better than walls [Walls] → [Blind spots]
LAW 29 Foresight prevents chaotic outcomes later. Think through consequences and endings before acting, avoiding unpredictable, uncontrollable results. Map outcomes before first move Unplanned actions invite disaster later [Start] →plan→ [End]	LAW 28 Hesitation broadcasts doubt and weakness. Commit to action with full boldness; timidity invites scrutiny and undermines your authority. Boldness masks minor mistakes well Timidity is punished more harshly [Bold] → [Respect]	LAW 27 Vague promises build devoted followers. Offer a vague vision and sense of belonging to attract deeply loyal, devoted followers. Ambiguity invites personal interpretation Belonging creates unquestioning loyalty [Vision] → [Followers]	LAW 26 Never take blame for mistakes. Use intermediaries to carry out dirty work, keeping your own image spotless and blameless. Scapegoats absorb blame for you Spotless image sustains long power [You] clean, [Agent] dirty	LAW 25 Design your own public image. Don't accept roles others assign you; craft and control a striking identity yourself. Self-made image beats given roles Bold identity commands attention, power [Old self] → [New image]	LAW 24 Master subtle diplomacy and flattery. Navigate hierarchies skillfully using charm, subtlety, and indirect flattery to gain favor. Read the room before acting Indirect praise beats blunt flattery [Tact] → [Favor]

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YAADCARD.IN

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KNOW
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LAW 35 Right moment multiplies your impact. Patience and precise timing determine whether an action succeeds or fails completely. Rushing ruins otherwise good plans Wait for the ripe moment [Wait] → [Strike]	LAW 34 Act regal to be treated regally. Carry yourself with confidence and dignity; others treat you as you present yourself. Self-image shapes others' treatment Confidence commands unearned respect [Act king] → [Treated so]	LAW 33 Every person has one weakness. Discover each person's hidden insecurity or need, then leverage it to influence them. Weakness reveals leverage points fast Insecurities are easiest to exploit [Weak spot] → [Leverage]	LAW 32 People crave escape, not reality. Appeal to people's fantasies and desires rather than harsh truths to win their favor. Truth often disappoints listeners Fantasy captivates and persuades faster [Fantasy] → [Buy-in]	LAW 31 Offer choices you already control. Give others a limited set of options so every choice they make still benefits you. Illusion of choice hides control All outcomes favor your interest [A B] → [You win]	LAW 30 Hide the labor behind results. Make hard-won accomplishments look natural and effortless; concealed effort impresses more. Visible struggle invites envy, doubt Ease implies natural superior talent [Hard work] →hide→ [Ease]
LAW 41 Successors are unfairly, harshly compared. Following a great predecessor invites unfair comparison; carve your own distinct path instead. Comparison to legends is unfair Build a fresh independent legacy [Legend] ≠ [New path]	LAW 40 Free gifts often carry hidden strings. Pay your own way when possible; free things often come with obligations or debts. Free favors create hidden debts Paying fully preserves your freedom [Free gift] → [Hidden cost]	LAW 39 Provoke anger to control rivals. Agitate opponents into anger; angry people make careless mistakes you can exploit. Anger clouds rational judgment fast Stay calm while rival loses composure [Stir] → [Mistake]	LAW 38 Conform outside, differ within privately. Keep unconventional beliefs private; publicly conform to avoid drawing unwanted hostility. Standing out invites social attack Private thoughts, public conformity [Inside/Outside]	LAW 37 Visuals persuade more than words. Striking imagery and symbolic display impress and persuade far more powerfully than explanations. Symbols stick longer than speech Grand displays build lasting impressions [Image] → [Impact]	LAW 36 Ignoring problems denies them power. Show contempt for things beyond your reach; chasing them only grants them more importance. Reacting grants problems more power Indifference is the best revenge [Ignore it] → [Loses power]
LAW 47 Overreaching turns victory into ruin. Stop once your goal is achieved; pushing further often turns success into painful loss. Success can breed reckless overreach Stop at the planned target [Goal] → [STOP]	LAW 46 Flaws humanize, prevent envy attacks. Show minor flaws occasionally; appearing flawless breeds envy and invites hidden resentment. Perfection provokes quiet jealousy Small flaws seem relatable, safe [Flawless] → [Envy]	LAW 45 Change slowly to avoid backlash. Advocate reform, but introduce change gradually; sudden shifts trigger fear and resistance. Sudden change sparks strong resistance Slow shifts feel safer, accepted [Old] →slow→ [New]	LAW 44 Reflecting others disarms, confuses them. Mimic an opponent's actions to unsettle and disarm them, making your own intent unclear. Imitation confuses and infuriates rivals Mirroring hides your true stance [You] ≈ [Rival]	LAW 43 Emotional appeal creates lasting loyalty. Understanding and appealing to others' emotions builds far more durable influence than force. Force breeds resentment, resistance later Emotional bonds create lasting obedience [Heart] → [Loyalty]	LAW 42 Remove the leader, scatter followers. Target the root troublemaker or leader directly; followers scatter once guidance is gone. Groups collapse without their leader Address the source, not symptoms [Leader gone] → [Chaos]